

# Running the DarshanEase Application

After completing the frontend and backend development, the **DarshanEase – Temple Darshan Ticket Booking System** can be executed by following the steps below.

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## Step 1: Start the Frontend (React Application)

### a) Open the Client Folder

Open **Visual Studio Code**, open the integrated terminal, and navigate to the **client** folder.

```
cd client
```

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### b) Start the React Development Server

Run the following command to start the frontend application.

```
npm run dev
```

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### c) Access the Frontend

After successful execution, the Vite development server starts and displays a local URL similar to:

```
http://localhost:5173
```

Open this URL in a web browser to access the **DarshanEase** user interface.

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## Step 2: Start the Backend (Node.js & Express Server)

### a) Open a New Terminal

Open another terminal window (or split the terminal) in Visual Studio Code.

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## b) Navigate to the Server Folder

Move to the backend project directory.

```
cd server
```

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# Step 3: Configure Environment Variables

Inside the **server** folder, create a file named **.env**.

Add the required environment variables to establish the database connection and configure the application.

Example:

```
PORT=5000
MONGO_URI=mongodb://127.0.0.1:27017/darshanease
JWT_SECRET=your_jwt_secret_key
```

If MongoDB Atlas is used, replace the local MongoDB URI with the Atlas connection string.

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# Step 4: Start the Backend Server

Inside the **server** folder, start the Express server using the following command:

```
npm run dev
```

or

```
nodemon server.js
```

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## Backend Server

After successful execution, the backend server starts on:

```
http://localhost:5000
```

The server connects to the MongoDB database and exposes REST API endpoints for user authentication, temple management, darshan slot booking, payments, and administrative operations.

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# Application Execution

Once both servers are running successfully:

- **Frontend (React):** <http://localhost:5173>
- **Backend (Express):** <http://localhost:5000>

The frontend communicates with the backend through REST APIs, enabling users to register, log in, browse temples, book darshan tickets, make payments, and manage bookings. The backend processes these requests, interacts with the MongoDB database, and returns the appropriate responses